

Because, because of, and so

Teaching guide

Give a reason and describe its result.

Understand the distinction

Because introduces a reason with a clause: because the bus was late. Because of introduces a noun phrase: because of the delay. So can introduce the result: The bus was late, so I walked.

In a simple standard-English sentence, choose one clear connection rather than because ... so A cause claim needs evidence; events happening together does not prove that one caused the other.

Compare the patterns

BECAUSE

I stayed home because I felt ill.

The reason is a clause.

BECAUSE OF

I stayed home because of a cold.

The reason is a noun phrase.

RESULT

I felt ill, so I stayed home.

So introduces what happened as a result.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. We stopped ____ the heavy rain.

A. so

B. because

C. because of

2. Join with so: The shop was closed. We came back later.

A. The shop was closed so of we came back later.

B. We came back later, so the shop was closed.

C. The shop was closed, so we came back later.

3. Choose the correction: Because I was tired, so I went home.

A. Because of I was tired, I went home.

B. Because I was tired, so of I went home.

C. Because I was tired, I went home.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Your bicycle needed repair, so you took the bus. Which sentence gives that reason correctly?

- A. My bicycle needed a repair because I took the bus.
- B. I took the bus because my bicycle needed a repair.
- C. I took the bus because of my bicycle needed a repair.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. because of

The heavy rain is a noun phrase.

A: So introduces a result, whereas the rain is the reason here.

B: Because normally takes a clause; the heavy rain is a noun phrase.

2. C. The shop was closed, so we came back later.

Put the result after so.

A: So connects the two clauses directly; do not add of.

B: This reverses the stated reason and result.

3. C. Because I was tired, I went home.

Alternatively: I was tired, so I went home.

A: Because of takes a noun phrase; I was tired is a clause.

B: Use because for the reason without so of.

4. B. I took the bus because my bicycle needed a repair.

Because introduces the clause giving the reason.

A: This reverses the stated cause and decision.

C: Because of takes a noun phrase, not this full clause.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-09.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Your bicycle needed repair, so you took the bus. Which sentence gives that reason correctly?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.